

The Romantic period

During the period (1820–1900), composers became more concerned with expressing emotion in their music. Non-professionals began to learn instruments themselves, music publishing flourished, and public concerts became increasingly popular.

Literary inspiration

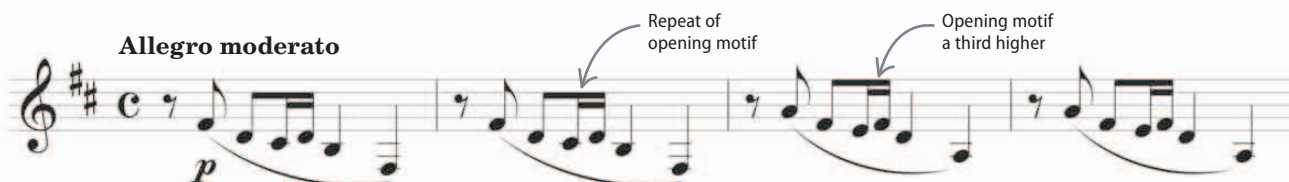
Classical themes, human relationships, and man's struggle against adversity inspired composers of the period. Goethe's *Faust* and the works of Dante and were strong influences, while contemporary German poetry provided the lyrics for songs by composers, notably Schubert, Schumann, and Brahms.

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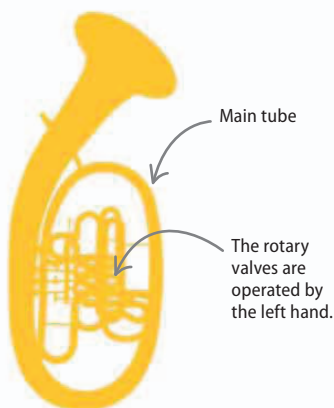
▽ *Fingal's Cave*

Mendelssohn's *Fingal's Cave* overture is an example of program music, which tells a story. The swirling opening theme suggests waves breaking at the mouth of the Hebridean cave.



New instruments, new colors

Technological developments made woodwind and brass instruments easier to play and more versatile in different keys. Mass production made them more affordable, so music-making at home became popular. Different sizes of standard woodwind and brass instruments were developed and new ones were invented, adding even more exciting colors and effects to the orchestra.



△ Wagner tuba

This brass instrument was invented for use in Wagner's operas. Resembling a small tuba, it is often played by French horn players.



△ Cor anglais

Sounding a fifth lower than the oboe, the cor anglais produces a darker, mellower sound, suitable for solos.

REAL WORLD

Music publishing

As printing became more efficient and cheaper, music was widely available to the public. The piano was a favorite home instrument for amateurs, so publishers arranged orchestral works for the piano, allowing people to get to know works they may not be able to hear in performance.

